






APPANOOSE COUNTY TOURISM

20 YEAR INVESTMENT & IMPACT REPORT

For two decades, tourism investments have strengthened our communities, supported local businesses, created jobs and improved quality of life for residents while welcoming visitors from near & far.

Appanoose County Tourism was established following separate ballot measures approved by voters in both Appanoose County the City of Centerville in 2004. The organization operates through an independent Tourism Commission consisting of three representatives appointed by Appanoose County Board of Supervisors, three representatives appointed by the City of Centerville, and three representatives appointed by PACT.

This report examines how those funds have been invested, the impact those investments have had throughout Appanoose County, and why tourism continues to be an important economic driver for the community.

KEY IMPACTS AT A GLANCE

$3.2M
INVESTED THROUGH GRANTS, MARKETING, EVENTS & TOURISM INITIATIVES

$815k
AWARDED IN TOURISM GRANTS TO LOCAL DESTINATIONS & NON-PROFITS

$39.2M
RECORDED VISITOR SPENDING IN 2024

344
JOBS SUPPORTED BY LOCAL TOURISM ECONOMY

$57.7M
TOTAL ECONOMIC IMPACT OF TOURISM IN 2024

$9.2M
ANNUAL STATE & LOCAL TAX REVENUE GENERATED BY VISITOR SPENDING

$316M
TOTAL VISITOR SPENDING IN APPANOOSE COUNTY SINCE 2016

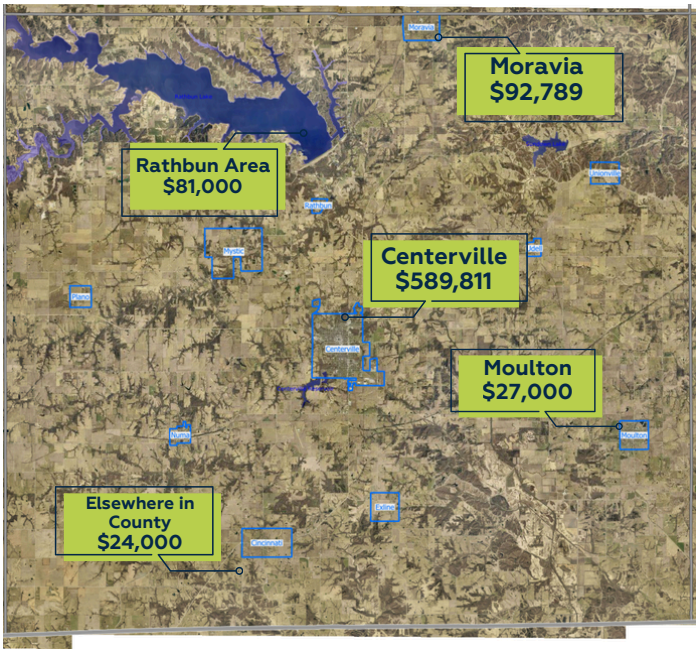
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COUNTY IN IOWA FOR ANNUAL TOURISM GROWTH

WHERE TOURISM DOLLARS
HAVE BEEN INVESTED

Tourism investments have supported projects, destinations and organizations throughout Appanoose County over the past 20 years.

GRANT AWARDS BY LOCATION

Since 2005



Top Project Types Funded

- Recreation & Parks
- Historic Preservation
- Festivals & Events
- Downtown Revitalization
- Tourism Marketing

NOTABLE GRANT FUNDED PROJECTS

APPANOOSE COUNTY CONSERVATION

$113,000+ AWARDED

Investments from Appanoose County Tourism have supported campground improvements, trails and recreation assets that attract visitors and improve quality of life for residents.


Upper Reservoir, Centerville



Water Tower, Mystic

HISTORIC PRESERVATION PROJECTS

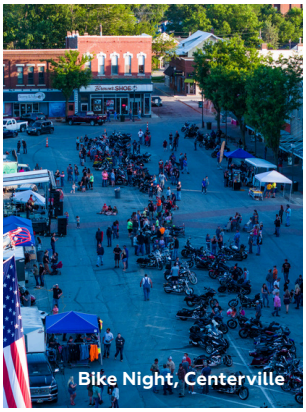
$230,000+ AWARDED

Funding has helped preserve local history across Appanoose County while creating attractions that draw visitors & strengthen community pride.

MAIN STREET CENTERVILLE

$91,000+ AWARDED

Early investment from Appanoose County Tourism helped build momentum & has resulted in $700k+ in state grant funds secured and $12M of private investment in the Main Street district.


Bike Night, Centerville


Trussel Park, Moravia

RECREATION IN APPANOOSE COUNTY

$105,000+ AWARDED

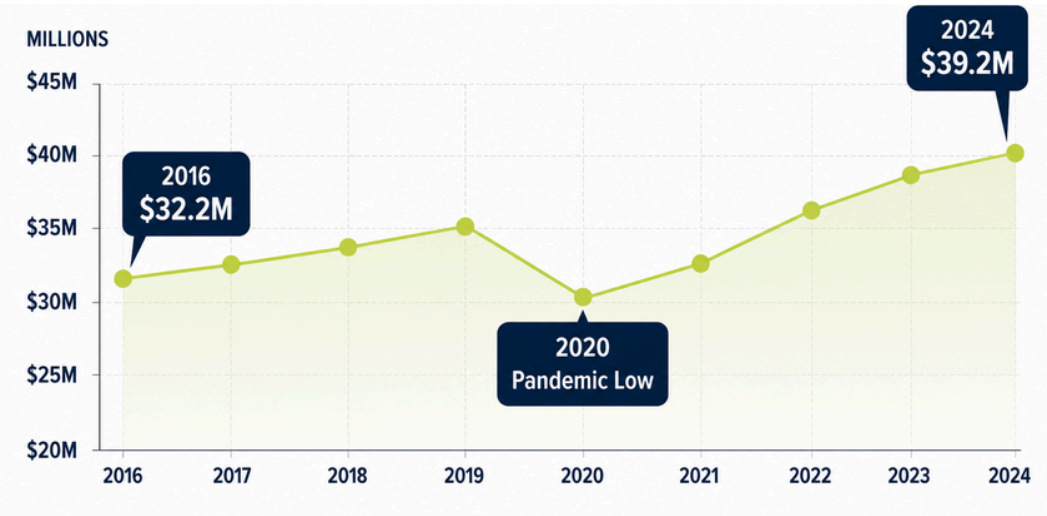
Tourism investments have helped enhance parks, trails, youth sports facilities, and outdoor attractions throughout Appanoose County.

TOURISM IS AN ECONOMIC DRIVER

Every tourism dollar spent in Appanoose County creates ripple effects throughout the local economy.

VISITOR SPENDING GROWTH

DATA SOURCED FROM TRAVEL IOWA TOURISM ECONOMICS REPORT



+21.7%
GROWTH IN VISITOR SPENDING SINCE 2016

+37.1%
GROWTH SINCE PANDEMIC LOW

2024 DIRECT SPENDING BY CATEGORY

(% increase year over year from 2023)

LODGING
$8.8M
8.5% ↑

FOOD & BEVERAGE
$8.6M
9.4% ↑

RECREATION
$5.3M
11.9% ↑

RETAIL
$6.0M
6.7% ↑

TRANSPORTATION
$10.5M
12.3% ↑

2024 TOTAL ECONOMIC IMPACT

$39.2M
IN VISITOR SPENDING

$11.3M
IN LABOR INCOME

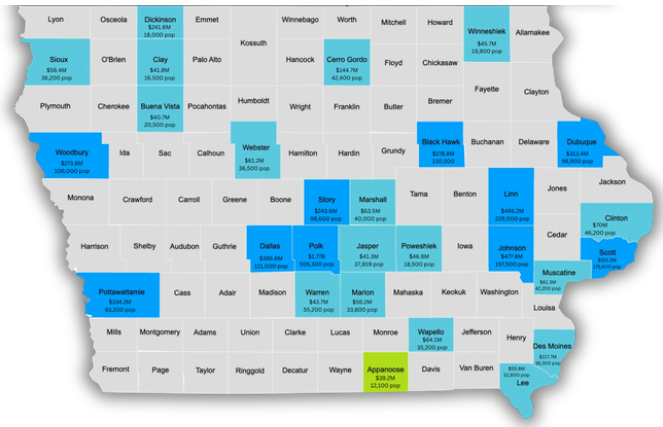
$9.3M
STATE & LOCAL TAX REVENUE

$57.7M
TOTAL ECONOMIC IMPACT

APPANOOSE COUNTY'S PLACE IN IOWA

#11

AMONG IOWA COUNTIES FOR ANNUAL TOURISM GROWTH RATE



LOOKING AHEAD



GROWING DESTINATIONS

Supporting destinations like Honey Creek Resort, Rathbun Lake, and other community attractions that give visitors a reason to choose Appanoose County for a weekend getaway, family vacation, or return visit.



OUTDOOR RECREATION

Enhancing campgrounds, trails, parks, disc golf, and recreational amenities that attract outdoor enthusiasts while creating experiences visitors can't find anywhere else.



VIBRANT DOWNTOWNS

Supporting historic districts, local businesses, and community improvements that make our communities welcoming places to shop, dine, and explore.



VISITOR EXPERIENCES

Creating and supporting signature events that bring thousands of visitors to Appanoose County each year and generate spending for local businesses.

INVESTING IN TOURISM IS INVESTING IN APPANOOSE COUNTY



APPANOOSE COUNTY TOURISM

96 LOCAL ORGANIZATIONS & BUSINESSES HAVE RECEIVED GRANT FUNDS SINCE 2005.

- AEDC
- All Play
- Appanoose County Baseball Association
- Appanoose County Coalition for the Arts
- Appanoose County Conservation Board
- Appanoose County Fair
- Appanoose County Foundation
- Appanoose County Historical Society
- Appanoose County Shooting Club
- Appanoose County Trails
- Appanoose Remembrance Tapestry Society
- Beyond Beauty Salon & Spa
- Bloom Greenhouse
- BOB Group
- Centerville Chamber of Commerce
- Centerville Concert Association
- Centerville Disc Golf Club
- Centerville Farmers Market
- Centerville Garden Club
- Centerville Municipal Airport
- Centerville Municipal Band
- Centerville Rotary Club
- Chariton Valley Paintball
- City of Centerville
- City of Cincinnati
- City of Exline
- City of Mystic
- City of Rathbun
- City of Udell
- Cooper Fields
- Darbyville Acres
- Deano's Complete Automotive
- Doggs RV Park
- Drake Public Library
- Exline Community Betterment Association
- Fire Department Car Show
- Flower-Tique
- Friends of Centerville Parks
- Friends of Oaklawn
- Game On Lazer Tag
- Generation Moravia
- Governor's Deer Hunt
- Gypsy Quarter
- Hardwood Hustle
- Harlem Ambassadors
- HCI Bank Club
- Historic Preservation Corporation
- Honey Creek Resort
- Hope Chest
- Humble Heroes
- IHCC
- Iowa Delta Kappa Gamma
- Iowa Media Network/GoPitchTV
- Iowa Pharmacy Association
- Junk Jaunt
- Kolton's Courts
- Lakeview PTO
- Little Flock Chapel
- Main Street Centerville
- Main Street Mercantile
- Material Girlz Quilt Guild
- Moravia Area Historical Society
- Moravia Community Betterment
- Moravia Fall Festival
- Moravia Fire & Rescue Association
- Moravia Fireworks
- Moravia Historical Society
- Moravia's Veteran & Historical Rock Committee
- Moulton Chamber of Commerce
- Moulton Community Sports Association
- Moulton Historical Society
- Moulton Jamboree
- Mystic 4th of July
- Mystic Fireworks
- Mystique Vintage & Unique
- Pancake Day
- Papo's Pumpkin Patch
- Pathfinders RC&D
- Planes, Trains & Automobiles
- Rathbun Lake Area YMCA
- Rathbun Lake Association
- Run of Rathbun
- Sheree's Flip Flop Tumbling
- Southern Iowa Junk Jaunt
- Tangleberries
- The Continental Hotel
- The HallTree
- The Quilted Frog
- True Impact Outdoors
- Valley View Event Center
- Veterans at Rathbun Lake
- VFW Post 526
- Walldogs
- WHO Tractor Ride
- Wildfire Creative
- ZKO Enterprises

Please Note: This list doesn't include projects funded through the Meet in Appanoose Grant